

ECON2106 - PRINCIPLES OF MICROECONOMICS

Spring 2026

Instructor:	Victoria Milani	Time:	T Th 9:55a.m. - 11:15a.m.
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Description: This course is designed to introduce students to the basics of Microeconomics. We will study how households and firms make decisions about the use of scarce resources in market economies, with emphasis on the role played by prices. We will study the characteristics of different types of markets, such as competitive and monopolistic ones. We will discuss the consequences of government involvement in the economy are studied, with examples taken from current policy issues.

Prerequisites: NA

Instructional Method: The course is delivered fully in-person, twice a week. Students are expected to attend all classes. **Office Hours** are held in person or via Zoom (zoom.us/j/6728377739)

Course Material:

- **Textbook:** *Principles of Microeconomics*, by Case, Fair and Oster, 14th edition, Boston: Prentice Hall (2020) (hereafter, CFO).
- **Online Platform:** MyLab Economics. You must purchase the 14th edition along with MyLab Economics access. To register for MyLab, follow the instructions appended to this syllabus.

Expected Learning Outcomes

By the end of this course, students should be able to:

- interpret economic models, such as supply and demand graphs, to assess relationships between policy interventions and market outcomes;
- synthesize information about current economic news and events and produce well-reasoned analyses to explain observed market dynamics and outcomes;
- support conclusions on market efficiency and welfare implications with sound economic reasoning;
- interpret and manipulate supply and demand models to predict market outcomes when external shocks occur, such as changes in input costs or government regulations;
- analyze elasticity concepts to evaluate the sensitivity of market demand and supply and understand their implications for pricing and tax incidence;
- assess real-world examples of market failures, such as externalities and public goods, by evaluating their underlying causes and implications;
- analyze the effects of policies like trade restrictions, zoning laws, price floors, and price ceilings considering both winners and losers;
- analyze opposing viewpoints on market failures, such as externalities and public goods, by examining various corrective policy approaches;
- recognize and discuss ethical issues in market structures, such as price discrimination and labor market practices.

Topical Outline:

1. Overview of Economics
2. Consumer Choice
3. Market Equilibrium
4. Elasticity
5. Firm Behavior
6. General Equilibrium
7. Monopoly, Oligopoly and Monopolistic Competition
8. Externalities
9. Public Goods, and Common Resources

Assignments and Grading Policy

Class Policy: Students are excused 5 absences during the semester. Above that, absence excuses are given only for University-excused absences. Students who are unable to attend class for an extended period of time due to an emergency/extenuating circumstance (i.e., medical illness, hospitalization, death in the family/bereavement, military or legal obligation), may contact the Student Care and Outreach at <https://sco.uga.edu> to request an absence notification.

Attendance will be assessed with interactive polls during class. During each class, you will be asked to answer one or more poll using your cellphone, computer or any device with internet access. These polls are not graded, but count as attendance. They are intended to help you and me to assess class understanding, and are mostly likely the exercises from MyLab Economics.

Grade Breakdown:

Homeworks	10%
Midterm #1	20%
Midterm #2	20%
Midterm #3	20%
Final Exam	30%

Homework: At the end of each chapter, I will assign a short homework for you to complete in MyLab Economics platform. You have as many attempts per homework as you want, but you **must complete all homework before the midterm-corresponding day**.

Midterms: There will be three midterm exams, administered online but during class hours, each covering parts of the material and similar to the homeworks and extra exercises from the MyLab Economics platform. Each exam will have a time limit of 60 minutes and will be closed-book.

Midterm #1: Tuesday, February 24th, in class → Ch. 2, 3, and 5.

Midterm #2: Thursday, March 26th, in class → Ch. 6, 7, 8, and 9.

Midterm #3: Thursday, April 23th, in class → Ch. 12, 13, 14, and 15.

Final Exam: The final exam is a comprehensive closed-book exam to take place on **Thursday, April 30th, from 8:00 a.m. to 11:00 a.m.**, at regular class meeting room.

It should include multiple choice, calculation questions, and short answer questions.

MyLab Economics Registration

Enrollment for MyEconLab course begins on Friday, January 9th, 2026. You do not need to enroll on/by January 9th (as our first class is not until Tuesday, January 13th). Rather, January 9th merely marks the start of the registration window. The MyLab registration window for this course will remain open until Monday, February 20th.

The tutorial on the last page provides step-by-step instructions on how to register for MyLab Economics and enroll in our course.

Policy Statements

UGA Student Honor Code: “I will be academically honest in all of my academic work and will not tolerate academic dishonesty of others.” A Culture of Honesty, the University’s policy and procedures for handling cases of suspected dishonesty, can be found at honesty.uga.edu.

Lack of knowledge of the academic honesty policy is not a reasonable explanation for a violation. Questions related to course assignments and the academic honesty policy should be directed to the instructor.

Use of AI for Coursework: Unless explicitly stated, artificial intelligence-based technologies, such as ChatGPT, must not be used to generate responses for student assignments.

UGA Well-being Resources: UGA Well-being Resources promote student success by cultivating a culture that supports a more active, healthy, and engaged student community. Anyone needing assistance is encouraged to contact Student Care & Outreach (SCO) in the Division of Student Affairs at 706-542-8479 or visit sco.uga.edu. Student Care & Outreach helps students navigate difficult circumstances by connecting them with the most appropriate resources or services. They also administer the Embark@UGA program which supports students experiencing, or who have experienced, homelessness, foster care, or housing insecurity. UGA provides both clinical and non-clinical options to support student well-being and mental health, any time, any place. Whether on campus, or studying from home or abroad, UGA Well-being Resources are here to help.

- Well-being Resources: <https://well-being.uga.edu>
- Student Care and Outreach: <https://sco.uga.edu>
- University Health Center: <https://healthcenter.uga.edu>
- Counseling and Psychiatric Services: <https://caps.uga.edu> or CAPS 24/7 crisis support at 706-542-2273
- Health Promotion/ Fontaine Center: <https://healthpromotion.uga.edu>
- Accessibility & Testing: <https://accessibility.uga.edu>

Additional information, including free digital well-being resources, can be accessed through the UGA app or by visiting [Well-being Resources](#).

Inclusive Excellence: The Terry College of Business is committed to promoting an inclusive learning and working environment among its students, faculty, and staff. This class welcomes the open exchange of ideas and values freedom of thought and expression and provides a professional environment that recognizes the inherent worth of every person. It aims to foster dignity, understanding, and mutual respect among all individuals in the class.

Disclaimer: The course syllabus is a general plan for the course; deviations announced to the class by the instructor may be necessary. My communications to the class will generally come through the eLC Announcements tool. You should set your notifications preferences to receive Announcements postings in the manner that suits you.

Tentative Course Schedule

Month	Day	Topic	Chapter
Jan	13	Introduction	-
	15	Scarcity and Choice	2
	20	Scarcity and Choice	2
	22	Demand, Supply, and Market Equilibrium	3
	27	Demand, Supply, and Market Equilibrium	3
	29	Demand, Supply, and Market Equilibrium	3
Feb	3	Demand, Supply, and Market Equilibrium	3
	5	Demand, Supply, and Market Equilibrium	3
	10	Elasticity	5
	12	Elasticity	5
	17	Household Behavior and Consumer Choice	6
	19	Household Behavior and Consumer Choice	6
	24	Midterm 1	2, 3, 5
	26	The Production Process	7
Mar	3	Short-Run Costs and Output Decisions	8
	5	Short-Run Costs and Output Decisions	8
	10	<i>Spring Break</i>	
	12	<i>Spring Break</i>	
	17	Long-Run Costs and Output Decisions	9
	19	Long-Run Costs and Output Decisions	9
	24	General Equilibrium and the Efficiency of Perfect Competition	12
	26	Midterm 2	6, 7, 8, 9
	31	Monopoly and Antitrust Policy	13
Apr	2	Monopoly and Antitrust Policy	13
	7	Oligopoly	14
	9	Oligopoly	14
	14	Monopolistic Competition	15
	16	Monopolistic Competition	15
	21	Externalities, Public Goods, and Common Resources	16
	23	Midterm 3	12, 13, 14, 15